

Mustakim Shikalgar

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EDUCATION

Arizona State University

Master of Science in Software Engineering, Data Science Specialization, GPA: 3.77/4.0

Tempe, AZ

May 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, TypeScript/Javascript, SQL

Backend & APIs: REST APIs, FastAPI, Django, gRPC, microservices, distributed systems, async programming

Machine Learning & AI: LangGraph, LangChain, LangSmith, RAG pipelines, PyTorch, LightGBM, scikit-learn

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, Prometheus, OpenTelemetry, Grafana

Data: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, pgvector, NATS JetStream

EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer & GenAI Team Lead

Jun 2026 – Present

Saayam for All

Remote

- Promoted to lead the GenAI team within weeks of joining; currently building **subject-line optimization** and **answer-generation endpoints** for the platform's help-request system
- Defined the technical architecture and roadmap for a **RAG-based conversational agent** replacing static FAQ lookup, including semantic query routing, persistent multi-turn session context, and token-budget cost controls, drawing on prior production AI experience

Software Engineer (Industry-Sponsored Capstone)

Jan 2026 – May 2026

METY Legal AI Platform, MyEdMaster

Tempe, AZ

- Owned **end-to-end backend architecture** for a 5-node LangGraph pipeline as part of a 6-person team across 7 Agile sprints, participating in peer code reviews and design discussions
- Cut per-query LLM cost **82%** (\$0.024 → \$0.0044) by removing an unconditional model call, routing classification/compression tasks to a smaller model, and consolidating two reasoning-node calls into one
- Designed a **two-layer security architecture** (stateless FastAPI service with zero DB credentials behind a Django API), with spaCy-based PII anonymization applied before any request reached the LLM
- Built and deployed backend services (Django REST API, FastAPI service, PostgreSQL) via **Docker and Kubernetes** across local and staging environments, supporting a multi-stage AI pipeline

SELECTED SOFTWARE ENGINEERING PROJECTS

AegisFlow | Python, FastAPI, Kubernetes, Redis, pgvector, NATS JetStream, OpenTelemetry

Feb – May 2026

- Architected a **7-microservice LLM reliability platform** (14 containers, 9,500+ lines) with a 5-component weighted confidence model routing outputs to accept, repair, fallback, or reject
- Built atomic Redis-based rate limiting (Lua/EVALSHA), circuit breakers with exponential cooldown, and an event-sourced replay engine reconstructing any execution from its trace ID
- Implemented hybrid retrieval (pgvector HNSW + keyword search fused via Reciprocal Rank Fusion) and instrumented the platform with 11 Prometheus metric families and OpenTelemetry tracing
- Validated reliability guarantees with a dedicated **chaos engineering service** that fault-injects failures across dependencies

Distributed Key-Value Store | Java 17, Raft Consensus, gRPC, Protocol Buffers, Docker

Jan 2024 – Dec 2025

- Implemented **Raft consensus** from scratch across a **5-node cluster**: leader election, log replication, and quorum-based commit, with automatic leader redirect on failover
- Benchmarked **17,857 ops/sec** write throughput and **sub-1 ms p99** read latency, validating **zero data loss** under simultaneous 2-of-5 node failure via automated fault-injection testing

Cascade | Python, FastAPI, LightGBM, PyTorch, NetworkX (in development)

Jun 2026 – Present

- Built a schema-driven graph intelligence platform (22 ADRs) with leak-free, purged/embargoed time-series evaluation; achieved **7-19% MAE reduction** vs. baseline via graph-augmented LightGBM, reporting an honest negative result (0 of 18 configs beat baseline on equities) rather than overstating performance

ACHIEVEMENTS

LeetCode: 881+ problems solved | Knight badge | Contest rating 1900+ | Top 3% globally | 130+ Hard

Publication: IEEE COMPSAC 2025, Missing Persons Knowledge Graph (27% acceptance rate)